

“Cloud and Hybrid Hosting are the Way to Go!”

Struggling with the complexities in the SLA (Service Level Agreement) of a data centre service provider? Well, here's some help. Today, when the cloud is the biggest phenomenon, it is important for IT admins to know what they are entitled to before inking an SLA. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** spoke to **Anil Chandaliya**, **chief network administrator, ESDS**, about how customers can play safe while dealing with data centres. Excerpts:



Q In the data centre business, what are the latest trends, particularly with respect to SMBs?

If you talk about SMBs, there are many companies trying to get on the cloud. They are curious about it. There are generally two kinds of customers: the first type are the SMBs that have their own IT teams and their decision maker is the IT manager, while in the second model, the SMBs have consultants. If they resort to consultants, the firms tend to follow their advice and consultants generally don't prefer the cloud or keeping the data in data centres. They still prefer keeping data within their premises because of certain inhibitions about storing data out of the office premises. The customers who have in-house IT managers are ready to take on different challenges and risks. They are IT savvy guys.

In the days to come, the adoption of the Cloud will surely increase. Also, hybrid hosting is one concept that is going to be a lot more prevalent for SMBs in times to come. In the case of hybrid hosting, there are many government

organisations and enterprises that have already invested in on-premise data centres. Such organisations are trying to get on to the cloud because now they have realised that they get many advantages with it. One of the main reasons is that they have a lot of server resources that are unutilised. In which case, the cloud becomes a great solution. A hybrid cloud can meet their dynamic requirements and it can save them money as well. It allows them to have in-house virtualisation and whenever required, they can connect to a public cloud and draw resources from there. This scaling can be done for the time being, where they have to pay only for the resources they use. They can scale down after their requirements are met.

Q Please share some details about the hybrid cloud and how secure it is.

IT admins are still not entirely convinced about the public cloud scenario, which is why hybrid clouds are coming into the picture. For example, in a bank set-up that has its database in its